

The Noble Auspicious Night Sūtra

Ārya Bhadrakatrī Nāma Sūtra · Toh 313 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་མཚན་བཟང་གཞི་བུ་འཁྲིད་

Toh 313 in the Kangyur is a short sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Bhadrakatrī Nāma Sūtra and in Tibetan as "The Noble Auspicious Night." The text belongs to the general sūtra literature of the Kangyur and takes the form of a nocturnal encounter in which a radiant deity descends to the bank of the Tapotā river near Rājagṛha and addresses a monk seated there in the night, prompting a teaching connected to auspicious conduct and the Dharma. The setting at Rājagṛha, in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove, places it within the classic framework of the Buddha's discourses, and the celestial visitor's appearance lends the text a luminous, devotional character. Though brief, the sūtra conveys an emphasis on practicing loving-kindness and the Dharma day and night, virtues celebrated as the hallmarks of the truly auspicious life.

may they always practice loving-kindness toward one another, and may they practice the Dharma day and night. The great sūtra entitled "The Noble Sūtra on Entering the City of Vaiśālī" is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya Bhadrakatrī Nāma Sūtra. In the Tibetan language: The Sūtra Called "The Noble Auspicious Night."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Rājagṛha, in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove. At that time a certain monk was sitting on the bank of the Tapotā river near Rājagṛha. Then a god of supreme and resplendent hue descended in the deep of night, went to where that monk was, and illuminated the entire bank of the Tapotā with a great and brilliant light. He then spoke to that monk, saying: "Monk, do you know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night?" The monk replied: "O god, I do not know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night. Do you, O god, know or not know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night?" The god replied: "Monk, I too do not know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night." The monk said: "O god, then who at present seeks the sūtra of the Auspicious Night?" The god replied: "The Blessed One is dwelling here in Rājagṛha, in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove. You should go into the presence of the Blessed One and request it, and then, just as the Blessed One instructs you, take it up and apply yourself to it diligently." Having said this, the god vanished right then and there.

Then that monk, rising at dawn, went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, that monk addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable one, last night in the darkness before dawn, a god of supreme and resplendent hue came to where I was and, having illuminated the entire bank of the Tapotā with a great and brilliant light, spoke to me thus: 'Monk, do you know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night?' I replied to him as follows: 'O god, I do not know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night. Do you, O god, know or not know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night?' He then said this to me: 'Monk, I too do not know the sūtra of the Auspicious Night.' I then said: 'O god, then who at present seeks the sūtra of the Auspicious Night?' He replied: 'The Blessed One is dwelling in Rājagṛha, in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove. You should go into the presence of the Blessed One and request it, and just as the Blessed One instructs you, take it up and apply yourself to it diligently.' Having said this, the god vanished right then and there. Venerable one, O Blessed One, I therefore request this matter fully."

The Blessed One declared: "Monk, do you know who that god was?" The monk replied: "Venerable one, I did not recognize that god." The Blessed One declared: "That son of the gods is the chief of the gods of the Thirty-Three and is called Candana (Sandalwood)." The monk said: "Venerable one, I wish to hear the sūtra of the Auspicious Night." The Blessed One declared: "Monk, for that reason listen well and hold it in mind, and I shall explain it to you. Monk, if a monk is endowed with three qualities, he is said to dwell in the sūtra of the Auspicious Night. What are the three? They are as follows:"

Not pursuing what is past, harboring no hope for what is to come, and remaining undistracted by phenomena arising in the present moment — a monk endowed with these three qualities is said to dwell in the sūtra of the Auspicious Night.

The Blessed One having declared this, the Sugata, the Well-Gone One, having spoken thus, the Teacher then further spoke these words:

One does not pursue the past.

One harbors no hope for what is to come.

What is past has ceased and gone;

what is to come has not yet arrived.

Whatever phenomena are arising now —
seeing each of them clearly as it is,

without being carried off by conceptual thought,
let all of that be thoroughly understood.

Who can know they will not die tomorrow?
Therefore let what must be done be done today.
With that great army of the Lord of Death
one cannot strike a bargain as a friend.

May all sentient beings, all living creatures,
all elemental spirits, all beings whatsoever,
attain happiness, and happiness alone;
may all be without affliction.

May all behold the good,
and may none come to any evil.

For one who dwells thus and strives with vigor,
with neither day nor night passing in idleness,
for that reason the sūtra of the Auspicious Night
has ever been proclaimed by the Sage.

Then, in order to protect all sentient beings, the Blessed One, having
explained this sūtra of the Auspicious Night, declared the following bases of
the mantra for warding off harmful wandering spirits:

Tadyathā — vinibharadī virini viraṇī buddhamahartānadhē mahini minani nini
nini nini titi titi titi virati gauri gandhāri caṇḍālī mātaṅgi pukasi brahmaṇi
dramiḍi dramiḍi śābhadi sadālabhe hinā matyam uttaraṇi maholana
dalabhani dalābhadre mahādalāni calāni ābhecakrabhaki mahācakrabhaki
śabari śabari mahāśabari bhucidgini bhuciriṅgini niminimiṅgini
nimindharibhūtāni svāhā.

Tadyathā — etu tutu tu natumirṇi kerṇi iṅku sudtaricalalā narata naramalulu
galulu avatraṇone śokanira bharadhasale tarakretar edhātu nodtu talalālu
vatabhaṭi yabhaṭiye svāhā.

Tadyathā — arakāte narakāte baṃsuka vayaiye kapotaka vayaiye tabhote ne
svāhā.

Any monk, or son of good family, or daughter of good family who, in order to
protect all sentient beings, holds the meaning, the words, the verses, and the
mantra bases for warding off harmful wandering spirits of this sūtra of the
Auspicious Night — whether carrying it, retaining it, reading it, contemplating

it, thoroughly mastering it, or extensively and correctly teaching it to others — fire shall not be able to harm that person's body, poison shall not be able to harm them, they shall not be subject to royal punishment, they shall not be subject to the punishment of thieves, they shall not die at an untimely hour, and they shall assuredly draw near to nirvāṇa.

In whatever birth and wherever one reads
the sūtra of the Auspicious Night,
one shall assuredly come to remember former births,
to arhatship, and to mastery.

By a single recitation in every place,
untimely death and the intermediate state are abandoned;
one does not bring upon oneself by one's own hand
untimely death and what is unlawful.

It protects and clears away all sentient beings'
illness, grief, fear, and birth;
bad dreams and sorrow —
reciting it turns these into glory.

For one who writes it and wears it at birth,
or places it upon a woman's body:
good fortune, radiance, and splendor
shall arise for that one.

Whatever non-virtue — however slight —
one has performed through body, speech, or mind,
all of that the Auspicious Sūtra
protects from untimely death.

Kings, water, fire, lightning —
famine, illness, enemies,
battle and combat as well —
if one remembers the Auspicious One, one is protected.

If one recites this vidyā mantra
and these secret mantras at all times,
people will be undaunted, always and in every season.
Therefore let this be recited with full attention of mind.

I prostrate to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas —
those of the past, those yet to come, and those arisen in the present. Having

prostrated, let these vidyā mantras be recited:

May I, through this vidyā mantra, come to be endowed with all good fortune.

Tadyathā: nimi nimir dhare, temi nimir dhare, timi timingali, trailoka avalokani, triśuladharaṇa, akuphini, krīmīkrīti, kilikili, kudto kudto, kudto kudsi, kurti kupiti.

May I and all sentient beings, together with Vajrapāṇi, be protected from all fears, all illness, all poisons, all epidemics, all malevolent spirits, all who are seized by the malicious, all thieves, all humans and non-humans, danger, harm, and all contagious disease, from strife, turmoil, wrongdoing, quarreling, divisiveness, all slander and exposure of faults, all harmful conduct of body, speech, and mind — protected, in every direction, from all fears. Protect! Protect!

Tadyathā: hili mili, cili, ili, mili, piśācī pārñāśa, varicili cili svāhā.

When the Blessed One had thus declared this, those monks and all the assembled retinue — the gods, humans, asuras, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), kinnaras (Skt. kinnara), great mahoragas (Skt. mahoraga), great yakṣas, rākṣasas (Skt. rākṣasa), hungry ghosts, and piśācas (Skt. piśāca) — all rejoiced in the world and gave full praise to what the Blessed One had declared.

The noble sūtra called the Auspicious Night is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The colophon at the opening marks the close of a preceding sūtra, the "Noble Great Sūtra on Entering the City of Vaiśālī," and the passage then transitions immediately into the opening of a new text, the Bhadrakatrī Sūtra. The Sanskrit title Ārya Bhadrakatrī Nāma Sūtra is preserved in transliteration in the Tibetan and is rendered accordingly. The river name "Tapotā" (Tibetan: ཐའོ་པོ་ཏ་ཀ་) refers to the hot-spring river Tapodarma near Rājagṛha, well attested in Buddhist literature. The god's name "Candana" is given in Tibetan as མཚན་དན་ (tsan dan), a standard transliteration of Sanskrit Candana, meaning "Sandalwood"; this is a known deity in the Trāyastriṃśa heaven. The passage closes mid-sentence, just as the Blessed One is about to enumerate the three qualities.

- The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering, which is itself a transcription of Sanskrit sounds. No attempt is made to restore a definitive Sanskrit original for the dhāraṇī syllables, as such phonetic transcriptions are inherently variable across manuscripts and the syllables are liturgically fixed rather than semantically transparent.

The final verse line "Kings, water, fire, lightning" appears to be the opening of a stanza that continues beyond the passage as given; the translation ends where the source text ends.

- The mantra syllables are rendered in approximate phonetic transliteration from the Tibetan

transcription. The underlying Sanskrit originals are uncertain in places, as the Tibetan phonetic rendering of mantra syllables does not always recover the Sanskrit precisely. This is a standard difficulty with dhāraṇī texts and is not consequential for the doctrinal content of the passage.

The term གུརུ་མ་ (garuḍa) literally means "sky-soarer" and is the standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit garuḍa, the great divine bird. It is glossed here on first occurrence for clarity.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.